



# Cafe Manager Seller's Guide

From Zero to Selling — The Complete A–Z Playbook

 v4.0 · Offline License System

Last updated: June 2026



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# 1 Understanding Your Product

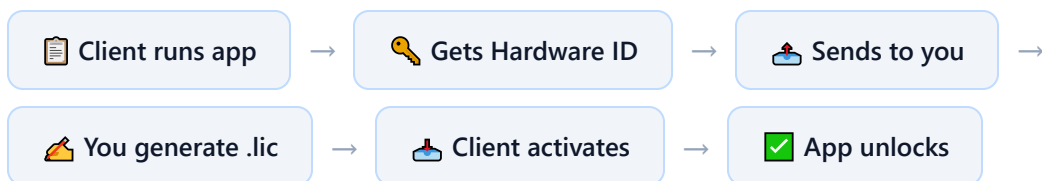
## What Is Cafe Manager?

Cafe Manager is a complete cafe/restaurant management system that runs **entirely offline** on a single Windows PC. It includes:

- **POS (Point of Sale)** — Take orders, split bills, print receipts
- **Order Management** — View, update, and track orders in real time
- **Menu Builder** — Categories and items with stock tracking
- **Inventory** — Track ingredients, set minimum levels
- **Table Management** — Regular tables + gaming stations (PlayStation, PC, billiards)
- **Employee Management** — Roles: admin, manager, cashier, waiter, kitchen
- **Reports & Accounting** — Daily/weekly/monthly sales, expenses, net profit
- **Business Day** — Open/close cash register with history
- **Customer Database** — Track customer info and history

## How the Licensing Works

Every installation is locked to a specific computer using a **hardware fingerprint** (CPU, RAM, MAC addresses, motherboard UUID). A license file ( `.lic` ) is cryptographically signed with **RSA-4096** (military-grade encryption) and can only be generated by *you* using your private key.



## What the Client Gets

- A folder called **CafeManager-Portable** (15–20 MB)
- Double-click "**Start Cafe Manager.bat**" to run
- Opens in their browser at `http://localhost:3001`
- No internet required (ever)
- No Node.js installation needed

- Database stored locally in a `data/` folder

## 2 One-Time Setup (Your Computer)

These steps only need to be done once. After this, you can generate licenses and build distribution packages whenever you need.

### Step 2.1 — Generate Your RSA Key Pair

 **This is the most important step.**

Your private key is what makes your license system secure. Anyone with your private key can forge licenses. Keep it safe.

```
# Navigate to the license-tool folder
cd license-tool
```

```
# Generate RSA-4096 key pair
node generate-keys.js
```

✅ RSA key pair generated!

private.pem → KEEP SECRET (use to sign licenses)  
public.pem → EMBED IN APP (use to verify licenses)

This creates two files in `license-tool/` :

| FILE        | WHAT IT IS                         | MUST NEVER SHARE |
|-------------|------------------------------------|------------------|
| private.pem | Your secret signing key            | ✅ Never share    |
| public.pem  | Verification key (embedded in app) | ❌ Safe to embed  |

 **BACKUP YOUR PRIVATE KEY!**

Copy `private.pem` to a USB drive, cloud storage (encrypted!), or print it as a QR code.  
**If you lose it, you cannot generate new licenses.**

## Step 2.2 — Build the React Frontend

The frontend needs to be compiled from React source into static HTML/JS files.

```
cd frontend
npm install           # Only needed once
npm run build         # Creates frontend/build/
```

## Step 2.3 — Create the Distribution Package

This packages everything your client needs into a single folder:

```
# From the project root
node scripts/package-dist.js
```

This creates `dist/CafeManager-Portable/` with:

```
CafeManager-Portable/
├─ Start Cafe Manager.bat ← Client double-clicks this
├─ README.txt ← Simple instructions
├─ backend/
│  ├─ server.js (obfuscated)
│  ├─ license.js (obfuscated)
│  ├─ routes/
│  ├─ database/
│  └─ node_modules/
├─ frontend/
└─ build/ ← Compiled React app
```

### 💡 Where to find things:

The distribution package is at `dist/CafeManager-Portable/`. Zip this entire folder to send to clients.

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## The License System Explained

### How It Works (Technical)

- 1. Hardware Fingerprinting** — On first run, the app reads CPU model, RAM, MAC addresses, and motherboard UUID to create a unique 32-character Hardware ID.
- 2. License File (.lic)** — A signed JSON file containing the hardware ID, client name, expiry date, and an RSA-4096 digital signature.
- 3. Signature Verification** — The app uses the embedded public key to verify the signature. If the signature doesn't match, the license is rejected.
- 4. Machine Locking** — The hardware ID in the license must match the local machine's fingerprint. Copying a license to another PC won't work.
- 5. Expiry Enforcement** — The app checks the expiry date on every request. Past the date = locked out.
- 6. Clock Tamper Detection** — If someone moves their system clock backward, the app detects the time drift and blocks access.

### Anatomy of a License File

```
{
  // Identifies the client's machine
  "hardware_id": "0635f0ca89f1f5b305e48b4ce501be1b",

  // Your client's name (for your records)
  "client_name": "Joe's Cafe",

  // When you issued it
  "issued_at": "2026-06-25",

  // When it expires (they can't use it after this date)
  "expires_at": "2026-09-23",

  // Version (reserved for future use)
  "version": 1,

  // RSA-4096 signature – this is what prevents forgery
  "signature": "H9f8G7h6J5k4L3m2N1b0V9c8X7d6E5f4..."
}
```

```
}
```

## What Happens Without a License

- The app starts but shows a **"License Required"** page
- The client's **Hardware ID** is displayed prominently
- All API endpoints return **403 Forbidden**
- The client can upload a `.lic` file directly through the browser
- Once a valid license is detected, the app unlocks completely



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## Onboarding Your First Client

This is the full flow from the moment a client agrees to buy your software. Follow these steps in order.

### Phase A: Client Gets the Software

1. **Zip the distribution package** — Right-click `dist/CafeManager-Portable/` → "Compress to ZIP" or use any archiver. The zip will be about 10–15 MB.
2. **Send it to the client** — Via email, Google Drive, WeTransfer, or USB stick. The client does not need internet to *use* the app, but they need internet to *receive* the files.
3. **Client unzips** — Anywhere on their PC (Desktop, C:\Program Files, etc.).
4. **Client double-clicks** `Start Cafe Manager.bat`.
5. **A browser opens** at `http://localhost:3001` showing the **License Required** page.

### Phase B: Client Gets Their Hardware ID

1. On the activation page, the **Hardware ID** is shown in a box. It looks like:  
`0635f0ca89f1f5b305e48b4ce501be1b`
2. The client copies this ID and sends it to you via email, WhatsApp, SMS, etc.
3. Tell the client to leave the server running.

#### Pro tip:

Ask the client to send you a screenshot of the activation page. That way you can see both the Hardware ID and confirm they reached the right page.

### Phase C: You Generate the License

1. Open a terminal/command prompt on **YOUR** computer.
2. Navigate to the project's `license-tool/` folder.
3. Run the license creator:

```
node create-license.js
```

#### 4. Enter the details when prompted:

Cafe Manager - License Creator

Enter hardware ID from client: 0635f0ca89f1f5b305e48b4ce501be1b

Enter client name (e.g. "Joe's Cafe"): Joe's Cafe

Expiry (date like "2026-12-31" or days like "30"): 90

✅ License created: Joe\_s\_Cafe.lic

Client: Joe's Cafe

Hardware: 0635f0ca89f1f5b305e48b4ce501be1b

Expires: 2026-09-23

File: /path/to/Joe\_s\_Cafe.lic

📧 Send this .lic file to your client.

#### ⚠️ Expiry formats you can use:

- 30 — 30 days from today
- 90 — 90 days from today
- 365 — 1 year from today
- 2027-12-31 — Specific date (YYYY-MM-DD format)

## Phase D: Client Activates

1. Send the .lic file to the client (email, WhatsApp).
2. The client has **two ways to activate**:

### Method 1: Through the browser (easiest)

- On the activation page, click "**Choose license file (.lic)**"
- Select the .lic file from their computer
- The page shows "✅ **License activated! Refresh the page to start.**"
- Refresh the page → The full Cafe Manager app loads!

### Method 2: Drop it in the folder

- Place the `.lic` file directly inside the `CafeManager-Portable/` folder
- Restart the app (close the command window and double-click the `.bat` again)

## Phase E: First Use

1. The app shows a login page.

2. Default credentials:

Email: `admin@cafe.com`  
Password: `admin123`

3. **Tell the client to change the admin password immediately!** Go to Employees page → Edit the admin user → Change password.

4. Guide the client through initial setup:

- Go to **Menu** → review/add menu items and prices
- Go to **Tables** → configure their table layout
- Go to **Employees** → add staff accounts
- Go to **Inventory** → set up stock items
- Go to **Business Day** → open the first business day

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## Managing Subscriptions & Renewals

### Pricing Models

Here are common pricing models you can use. The system supports any of them equally well:

#### Monthly

**\$29**/mo

- ✓ Full features
- ✓ Email support
- ✓ Monthly renewal

#### Recommended

#### Quarterly

**\$79**/3mo

- ✓ Full features
- ✓ Priority support
- ✓ Quarterly renewal
- ✓ Best value

#### Yearly

**\$249**/yr

- ✓ Full features
- ✓ Priority support
- ✓ Annual renewal
- ✓ Best discount

### Renewal Workflow

When a client's license is approaching expiry or has expired:

- 1. Client contacts you** — They see "License expired on [date]" when trying to use the app. They email or message you.

2. **Client sends their Hardware ID** — It's still displayed on the expired license page. (The hardware ID doesn't change, so you can also keep it in your records.)
3. **You verify payment** — Check that they've paid for the renewal period.
4. **You generate a new license** — Same process as before:

```
cd license-tool
node create-license.js

# Enter same Hardware ID, same client name, new expiry
```

5. **Send the new .lic file** — The client replaces the old one in their app folder and restarts the app.

#### **Keep a client spreadsheet:**

Track each client's name, hardware ID, license file name, issue date, and expiry date.  
When they contact you for renewal, you already have their hardware ID ready.

## Handling Non-Payment

When a client doesn't renew:

- **Don't send a new license file** — Simple as that. The old one expires on its own.
- The app becomes unusable (shows "License Required" page).
- The client's data **remains intact** in the database. If they pay later, a new license will restore access with all their data.
- There's no way for the client to bypass the expiry without a signed license from you.

## Offering a Trial

Want to let clients try before they buy?

- Generate a license with a short expiry like **7** (7 days) or **14** (14 days)
- Send it to the prospect. They activate it just like a paid license.
- When it expires, they either buy or lose access.
- No need to change anything in the app — the license system handles it all.

## 6 Building & Distributing Updates

### When You Release an Update

When you make improvements or fix bugs, you need to rebuild the distribution package and send it to your clients.

- 1. **Make your changes** — Edit the source code in `backend/` and `frontend/`.
- 2. **Rebuild the frontend:**

```
cd frontend
npm run build
```

- 3. **Rebuild the distribution package:**

```
cd .. (back to project root)
node scripts/package-dist.js
```

- 4. **Send the new folder** to your clients (or just the changed files if you want to be selective).

 **Client data is NOT affected by updates.**  
The database is stored in `backend/database/cafe.db` (inside their app folder). As long as the client replaces the backend files but keeps the database, all their data is safe.  
**Always tell clients to backup their database before updating!**

### What to Update: Full vs. Partial

| YOU CHANGED...                         | SEND CLIENT...                                          |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Backend code (routes, license, server) | Entire <code>backend/</code> folder (but keep database) |
| Frontend (UI, pages, styles)           | Entire <code>frontend/build/</code> folder              |

## YOU CHANGED...

## SEND CLIENT...

Both

Entire distribution package (fresh install)

 **For minor updates:**

You can just ZIP the new `dist/CafeManager-Portable/` folder and send it. The client unzips it somewhere new, copies their `license.lic` and `backend/database/cafe.db` from the old install, and they're good to go.

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## Anti-Piracy & Code Protection

### The Protection Layers

Your software has multiple layers of protection. Each layer makes it harder for someone to steal or resell your work.

| LAYER                                 | WHAT IT DOES                                                                                                          | BYPASS DIFFICULTY                                                        |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Code Obfuscation</b>            | Scrambles variable names, flattens control flow, strings are encrypted. Makes the source code unreadable.             | ☆☆ Medium — Determined hackers can reverse it                            |
| <b>2. RSA-4096 Signatures</b>         | License files must be digitally signed by your private key. Forging a signature is computationally infeasible.        | ☆☆☆☆☆ Impossible — Would take centuries to crack                         |
| <b>3. Hardware Locking</b>            | License only works on the specific machine it was issued for. Can't copy licenses between computers.                  | ☆☆☆☆ Very hard — Would need to spoof hardware IDs                        |
| <b>4. Clock Tamper Detection</b>      | Detects if someone moves their system clock backward to extend the license.                                           | ☆☆☆ Hard — Can be bypassed by freezing the clock before starting the app |
| <b>5. .exe Compilation (optional)</b> | Compiles everything into a single .exe. Much harder to extract code from a compiled binary than from plain .js files. | ☆☆☆☆ Very hard — but not impossible                                      |



 **The Important Truth:**

No offline software is 100% piracy-proof. If it runs on someone else's machine, they technically have the code. The goal is to make stealing it **harder and more expensive**

than just paying you. For a cafe owner paying \$29/month, hiring someone to crack the software would cost way more.

## What Can't Be Protected Against (And That's OK)

- **System clock manipulation** — A determined user could freeze their clock or use VM snapshots. The anti-tamper detection makes casual cheating difficult.
- **Memory dumping** — Running code is decrypted in memory. A skilled hacker could dump and analyze it.
- **Redistribution by a trusted client** — If someone buys a legitimate license and shares their copy with a friend, the friend won't have the right hardware ID. The license won't work.

## Optional: Build a Single .exe

For extra protection, you can compile the app into a single Windows executable. This bundles Node.js + all code into one `.exe` file. The build script is provided but may need adjustments depending on your system.

```
# Build using the @yao-pkg/pkg fork (better compatibility)
node scripts/build-exe.js
```

The output goes to `dist/CafeManager.exe`. You then distribute just the `.exe` + `.lic` file instead of the whole folder.

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## Client Support & Troubleshooting

### Common Issues Clients Encounter

#### Issue: "Node.js is not recognized" error when running the .bat

**Cause:**

The client doesn't have Node.js installed on their system. The current distribution package expects Node.js to be available.

**Solution:** Ask them to download and install Node.js from [nodejs.org](https://nodejs.org) (the LTS version, ~25 MB installer). After installation, restart the .bat file. Alternatively, you can bundle a portable Node.js in the distribution for a fully self-contained package.

#### Issue: Browser shows blank page or "Cannot connect"

**Solution:** Check that the command window is still open (closing it stops the server). Make sure they're visiting exactly `http://localhost:3001` (not HTTPS, not a different port). If the port 3001 is already in use, close other programs and try again.

#### Issue: "License required" page keeps showing after placing .lic file

**Solution:** Make sure the file is named exactly `license.lic` (not `license (1).lic` or `Joe_s_Cafe.lic`). The app automatically detects any `.lic` file, but the upload method in the browser is more reliable. Try uploading through the browser instead.

#### Issue: "License expired" on a new computer

**Solution:** The license is locked to the original machine's hardware ID. If the client gets a new computer, they need a new license. Your process: ask for the new Hardware ID → generate a new .lic → send it to them.

#### Issue: "System clock tampering detected"

**Solution:** The client's computer date/time was changed. Ask them to:

1. Right-click the clock in the taskbar → "Adjust date/time"
2. Turn on "Set time automatically"
3. Click "Sync now"
4. Restart Cafe Manager

If the issue persists, delete the `data/.license-check` file in the app folder and restart.

### Issue: Accidentally deleted the database

**Solution:** Check the `backend/backups/` folder. The app creates automatic daily backups at 4 AM (keeps last 30 backups). To restore, replace the `cafe.db` file with a backup.

## Support Workflow (For You)

- 1. Client reports issue** — Ask for a screenshot and description.
- 2. Check the server log** — The command window shows real-time logs. Ask the client to copy any error messages they see.
- 3. Common fixes first** — Restart the app, check the `.lic` file, check the system clock, reinstall the app (keep the database).
- 4. If nothing works** — Ask the client to send you their `backend/database/cafe.db` file. You can run it locally to diagnose issues.
- 5. For critical bugs** — Fix the issue, rebuild the distribution, send them an update.

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## Business Operations

### Setting Your Pricing

Research your local market. Cafe/restaurant POS systems typically cost:

| PRODUCT TYPE                        | TYPICAL MONTHLY COST                         |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Cloud POS (Toast, Square)           | \$50–\$200/month + 2–3% per transaction      |
| On-premise POS (Lightspeed, KORONA) | \$100–\$300/month + setup fees               |
| <b>Your Cafe Manager</b>            | <b>\$29–\$79/month</b> — no transaction fees |

Your advantage: **fully offline, no per-transaction fees, no internet dependency**. This is a huge selling point for cafes in areas with unreliable internet.

### Keeping Records

For each client, keep a simple spreadsheet (Excel, Google Sheets, or just a text file):

| CLIENT NAME | HARDWARE ID | LIC FILE       | ISSUED     | EXPIRES    | PLAN      | PAYMENT STATUS |
|-------------|-------------|----------------|------------|------------|-----------|----------------|
| Joe's Cafe  | 0635f0ca... | Joe_s_Cafe.lic | 2026-06-25 | 2026-09-23 | Quarterly | ✓ Paid         |
| Blue Mug    | a1b2c3d4... | Blue_Mug.lic   | 2026-07-01 | 2026-07-31 | Monthly   | ✓ Paid         |

### Payment Collection

Since the app is offline, you need to collect payments separately. Options:

- **Bank transfer** — Client sends to your account. Most professional for businesses.
- **PayPal / Venmo / CashApp** — Quick and easy for smaller payments.
- **WhatsApp Pay / Google Pay** — Popular in some regions.
- **Stripe / Paddle** — More formal with automated invoicing.

**Pro tip:** Offer a discount for annual payment. It reduces your admin work and gives you cash upfront. E.g., \$249/year instead of  $\$29 \times 12 = \$348$ .

## Scaling Your Business

- **Start with friends and local cafes** — Offer a discount in exchange for testimonials.
- **Create a simple website** — Just one page describing features and pricing.
- **Offer installation as a service** — Some clients will pay extra for you to set everything up.
- **Consider annual maintenance contracts** — Charge a premium for priority support and updates.
- **Version 5.0 ideas** — Multi-location support, cloud backup option, loyalty programs.

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# Quick Reference

## Command Cheat Sheet

| ACTION                   | COMMAND                                                        | RUN FROM             |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Generate key pair        | <code>cd license-tool &amp;&amp; node generate-keys.js</code>  | Project root         |
| Create a license         | <code>cd license-tool &amp;&amp; node create-license.js</code> | Project root         |
| Build frontend           | <code>cd frontend &amp;&amp; npm run build</code>              | Project root         |
| Package for distribution | <code>node scripts/package-dist.js</code>                      | Project root         |
| Build .exe (optional)    | <code>node scripts/build-exe.js</code>                         | Project root         |
| Run in dev mode          | <code>cd backend &amp;&amp; node server.js</code>              | Project root         |
| Read server logs         | Look at the terminal window                                    | Wherever server runs |

## File Locations

| FILE        | WHERE IT IS                      | PURPOSE                                                                                                              |
|-------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| private.pem | license-tool/                    |  Your secret key — never share! |
| public.pem  | license-tool/ + embedded in app  | Public key for signature verification                                                                                |
| *.lic       | license-tool/ (after generation) | License file for a client                                                                                            |

| FILE                  | WHERE IT IS                        | PURPOSE                             |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| CafeManager-Portable/ | dist/                              | Distribution package (zip and send) |
| license.lic           | App folder (on client's PC)        | Active license file                 |
| cafe.db               | backend/database/ (on client's PC) | All data (keep safe!)               |

Client Communication Templates

Welcome Email (New Client)

**Subject:**

Welcome to Cafe Manager — Here's Your Software

Hi [Client Name],

Thank you for choosing Cafe Manager! Your software is attached to this email. Please follow these steps to get started:

1. Unzip the attached **CafeManager-Portable.zip**

2. Open the folder and double-click **"Start Cafe Manager.bat"**

3. A browser will open showing your **Hardware ID** — copy it and reply to this email

4. I'll send you your license file within 24 hours

Need help? Just reply to this email.

Best,  
[Your Name]

License Delivery

**Subject:**

Your Cafe Manager License — [Client Name]

Hi [Client Name],

Your license file is attached. Here's how to activate:

**Option 1 (Easiest):**

- On the License Required page, click "Choose license file"

- Select the attached

**[filename].lic**

file

- Refresh the page — you're in!

**Option 2:**

- Place the .lic file in your CafeManager-Portable folder

- Restart the app

**Expiry:**

Your license is valid until [Date].

You'll receive a renewal reminder before it expires.

Best,

[Your Name]

**Renewal Reminder**



**Subject:**

Your Cafe Manager License Expires Soon

Hi [Client Name],

This is a friendly reminder that your Cafe Manager license expires on

**[Date]**

.

To continue using the app, please send [Amount] via [payment method] to renew for another [period].

Once confirmed, I'll send you a new license file right away.

Best,

[Your Name]

## Quick Troubleshooting Checklist

1. ☐ Is the command window still open? (Closing it stops the server)
2. ☐ Is the .lic file in the right folder? (Should be in the same folder as the .bat file)
3. ☐ Is the .lic file named correctly? (Any name works, but must end in `.lic` )
4. ☐ Is the system clock set correctly? (Wrong date = "expired" or "tampering detected")
5. ☐ Is there a previous .lic file interfering? (Delete old ones, keep only the latest)
6. ☐ Has the hardware changed? (New computer = new license needed)
7. ☐ Restart the app (close and reopen the .bat file)
8. ☐ Restart the computer



**Cafe Manager v4.0** — Seller's Guide

Built with the offline license system

